# A REPORT ON POLICE STAFF RECRUITMENT GOALS AND COSTS

**June 15th, 2026**

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## Executive Summary

On February 12, 2026, Portland City Council adopted Resolution 2026-042 directing the Deputy City Administrator for Public Safety to prepare a report on police officer recruitment goals and the costs of achieving and sustaining increased staffing levels. This report responds to that direction by examining the Portland Police Bureau's current staffing conditions, the factors that affect recruitment and retention, the workload pressures facing the bureau, and the likely timelines and cost categories associated with increasing sworn staffing. The report is intended to support evidence-based decision-making and public discussion; it is not a staffing plan, nor does it endorse a specific staffing target or policy option.

Rather than evaluate police staffing using a simple officers-per-capita ratio, which national professional organizations and policing experts caution against relying on, this report uses a workload-based framework: what work is the Police Bureau expected to do, how often does that work occur, how much time does it take, and what level of performance does the City expect?

The Portland Police Bureau currently has 877 authorized sworn positions and 342 authorized non-sworn positions. However, the bureau cannot currently afford to fill all authorized positions within its existing appropriation while maintaining current overtime levels[1]. The bureau continues to rely heavily on overtime to sustain core operations, including patrol backfill and mission-based enforcement. At the same time, several performance areas show significant strain. Average response times for high-priority calls have increased substantially over the past decade, investigative capacity is constrained across several serious case types, and officers have limited time available for proactive patrol, community engagement, and problem-solving work.

The report identifies several areas where PPB's workload could expand if additional staffing were available. These include patrol capacity, investigative follow-up, traffic enforcement, specialty missions, community engagement, victim support services, and potential future organizational changes such as a four-precinct model. It also identifies areas where sworn workload could decrease through internal efficiencies, civilianization of certain functions, and continued diversion of appropriate call types to other responders. These potential reductions are important, but they do not eliminate the need to understand PPB's core staffing requirements.

[1] See later sections for why overtime rates would likely increase in the short term before coming down over time with increased hiring.

Increasing staffing is not simply a matter of authorizing new positions. While it takes nearly two years for a new officer to complete hiring, academy training, field training, and probation, many recruits are working on their own during their final 4-6 months of probation and are counting towards staffing.

Approximately 25 percent of trainees separate before completing probation. The bureau must also offset retirements, resignations, promotions, and other internal movement before net staffing increases are realized. Under current baseline assumptions, the bureau is projected to grow gradually over time, but actual outcomes could vary significantly depending on hiring success, retention, labor market conditions, pension-driven retirement patterns, and broader social or economic factors.

The report models a range of staffing scenarios rather than a single forecast. Under a status quo model, PPB would **net increase staffing by 5.5 sworn personnel per quarter on average**. More optimistic scenarios assume higher hiring and improved retention; less favorable scenarios assume lower hiring and higher separations. These scenarios are intended to show the range of plausible outcomes and the sensitivity of long-term forecasts, not to predict exact staffing levels. Projections become less reliable the farther they extend into the future and should be updated regularly as conditions change.

The report identifies the major cost categories that Council should consider when evaluating staffing expansion. These include recruitment, the cost of hiring and training each new officer through the nearly two-year probationary period before they become independently deployable, ongoing salary and benefit obligations, non-sworn support positions, and an **estimated $338 million in long-term capital needs** for facility replacement and potential new precincts. The report also identifies possible offsets, including an **estimated $13 million in reduced overtime spending**, reimbursed positions through an expanded intergovernmental agreement with TriMet, and avoided costs from improved retention. Under the status quo recruitment scenario, the annual cost of sustaining a larger sworn workforce is estimated at approximately **$37.3 million annually above current levels by FY 2035–36**, net of overtime savings. This figure reflects sworn personnel costs only and does not include capital, non-sworn staffing, or the effects of inflation — all of which would add to the total fiscal obligation.

Ultimately, this report frames police staffing as a policy question as much as a technical one. The number of officers Portland needs depends on what council and the community expect PPB to achieve: faster response times, a greater range of reports being assigned to investigation, higher investigative clearance rates, more proactive patrol, expanded traffic enforcement, stronger community engagement, reduced overtime reliance, or some combination of these outcomes. Future staffing decisions should therefore be tied to clear

performance expectations, transparent cost estimates, sustained public input, and a broader understanding of Portland's evolving public safety system.

# Section 1: Introduction and Policy context

## Background on the resolution and its intent

On February 12, 2026, the Portland City Council adopted a resolution directing the Deputy City Administrator for Public Safety to prepare a report assessing police officer recruitment goals and the associated costs of achieving and sustaining those staffing levels. The resolution reflects Council's interest in grounding public safety staffing discussions in clear data, realistic timelines, and transparent accounting of costs. Council requested analysis related to organizational structure, recruitment and training capacity, workforce retention trends, and the full fiscal implications of increasing sworn staffing within the Portland Police Bureau (PPB).

This request comes at a time when Portland, like many cities across the United States, is evaluating how best to structure and resource its public safety system. Council indicated that a transparent, fact-based analysis of recruitment goals, staffing capacity, and associated costs would help inform public discussion and future policy decisions.

## Prior police staffing analysis

In 2014 the City of Portland contracted with Matrix Consulting to conduct a staffing study which was delivered in March 2015. The report made several recommendations, including increasing the number of PPB positions by 27.5[2] (from an actual sworn number of 924 in 2015), and a number of recommendations around reorganization and efficiency.

An updated analysis[3] in 2016, concluded that while authorized sworn positions had increased, actual sworn continued to decline. The report concluded that 448[4] officers would need to be assigned to patrol in order to meet the service levels identified in the Matrix report (330-335 officers were assigned to patrol at that time – in 2026 that number is still 336[5]).

In 2019 an updated analysis of patrol staffing was conducted by PPB's Strategic Services Division (SSD) which recommended a rebalancing of patrol staffing to reflect changes in precinct population sizes and call volume patterns. After being implemented, the changes were reverted during 2020. Another patrol staffing plan has been developed by SSD and shared with the Chief's Office.

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[2] 11 of these would be officers, 7 detectives, 5 sergeants, 2 fewer lieutenants, 1 fewer captain, and 7.5 more non-sworn positions. The 2015 authorized numbers were 948 sworn and 251 professional (total 1,199).
[3] https://www.portland.gov/budget/performance/documents/presentation-june-26-2016/download
[4] To meet the recommended increase the PPB would have had to recruit 76 officers per year for the next five fiscal years (the average from the previous 5 was 25 per year).
[5] https://www.portland.gov/police/open-data/ppb-staffing-report

## Relationship to related ongoing work

As part of broader discussions on public safety policy that gained energy in 2020, an initiative was launched to examine the way in which 911 calls are allocated. In 2022 the city contracted with Mission Critical Partners (MCP) to perform a public safety provider call allocation and staffing study.

Following MCP's report a working group comprising BOEC, PPB, PSR, and PSSA staff was convened, and reported preliminary recommendations in October 2025. In April 2026 further recommendations were made concerning the "welfare check" call type, recommending that "*where there is no evidence to suggest a concern about the safety of the public, responders, or a criminal nexus, alternative responders should be the primary response*" and that approximately 14,000 welfare check dispatches per year can and should be moved over to PSR from PPB. This transfer is estimated to take four years if implemented.

As of the writing of this report, the FY 2026–27 budget has not yet been adopted. The Mayor's Proposed Budget includes changes to the bureau's authorized staffing levels and organizational structure that, if adopted, would affect the baseline assumptions used in this analysis. This report uses the bureau's current authorized staffing as its starting point and does not incorporate proposed budget changes. Council should consider the adopted budget when evaluating the staffing scenarios and cost projections presented here.

### *Workload-based calculations of number of staff needed*

The International Association of Police Chiefs (IACP), the Police Executive Research Forum (PERF), and the International City/County Management Association Center for Public Safety Management (ICMA/CPSM) recommend using a workload-based approach instead of a per-capita number of officers. Instead of using population ratios, this method calculates the number of needed officers based on actual demand for police services, activity intensity, and time required to complete tasks. The steps taken to make this calculation are:

1. Calculate total workload hours of core tasks.
2. Add "uncommitted time" to account for preventive patrol, community engagement, problem-solving, backup availability, etc. The typical benchmarks are 60-70% committed time and 30-40% uncommitted time.
3. Calculate available officer time – from 2,080 total work hours per officer per year, subtract vacation, sick leave, training, wellbeing time, court time, administrative time, etc. Typical net available time is approximately 1,400-1,600 hours per officer per year.
4. Convert workload into numbers of officers.
5. Account for minimum staffing/deployment constraints – minimum officers per shift, geographic coverage, response time targets, peak demand (time-of-day variation), and shift-based modeling (hour by hour demand curves).

6. Add relief factor to cover time off when officers are not on duty – i.e. to staff one position 24/7 needs ~1.7 officers.
7. Validate estimated staffing levels against performance metrics (e.g. target response times, acceptable queueing, officer availability).
8. Extend first stage analysis of patrol response to include investigations and specialty units (i.e. caseload analysis – cases per investigator, clearance expectations, complexity of cases).

## What this report is not

The analysis presented here is intended to support evidence-based decision-making. This report does not constitute a staffing plan for the Portland Police Bureau or the service area, nor does it represent an endorsement of any particular staffing target or policy option presented within it. Developing a staffing plan would require deeper analysis of operational workload, further engagement with the community and Council on public safety priorities and performance expectations, and alignment with ongoing work by bureau and city staff.

## Section 2: Current service level

### Current Programs and Staffing

The Portland Police Bureau is organized into three branches - Operations, Investigations, and Services - each of which plays a distinct role in delivering public safety services to the City.

The Operations Branch is the largest component of the bureau and is responsible for responding to 911 calls, conducting patrol, and carrying out targeted enforcement missions. It includes three precincts (Central, East, and North) which collectively cover the city's approximately 145 square miles and handle more than 200,000 calls for service annually. Each precinct maintains a Neighborhood Response Team of officers and a sergeant focused on chronic community problems such as property crime patterns, nuisance complaints, and high-impact locations. In addition to routine patrol, the Operations Branch conducts enforcement missions that include stolen vehicle recovery, retail theft, narcotics suppression, street racing interdiction, and directed crime reduction patrols. These missions are frequently carried out in coordination with other precincts, regional law enforcement partners, and community stakeholders. Patrol officers also perform the preliminary stages of most investigations, including gathering statements, collecting evidence, identifying suspects, and documenting cases before they are referred to detectives for follow-up.

The Investigations Branch handles more complex and serious cases that require sustained follow-up beyond the initial patrol response. It includes the Detective Division, which houses specialized units for person crimes, property crimes, domestic violence, family services, and human trafficking investigations. Detectives lead interagency and prosecutorial coordination, work closely with the Multnomah County District Attorney's Office, and are supported by the bureau's Victim Services Unit. The branch also includes the Specialized Resources Division, which oversees units with distinct operational roles: the Focused Intervention Team and Enhanced Community Safety Team, both central to the City's Ceasefire gun violence reduction strategy; the Special Emergency Reaction Team (a high-risk tactical unit); the Air Support Unit; the Rapid Response Team for public order events; and the Narcotics and Organized Crime Unit, which conducts large-scale drug interdiction investigations. The Forensic Evidence Unit and Property and Evidence Division round out the branch, providing crime scene processing, evidence collection, and chain-of-custody management.

The Investigations Branch also includes the Traffic Division, which supports the City's Vision Zero commitment through traffic enforcement, serious and fatal collision investigations, and DUII enforcement, as well as the Public Safety Support Specialist (PS3) program, which assigns civilian staff to precincts to write reports, follow up on lower-level property crimes, and provide community-facing non-enforcement services.

The Services Branch provides the internal support functions that sustain the bureau's operational capacity. This includes the Personnel Division, which handles recruitment, hiring, and human resources; the Training Division, which oversees academy classes, in-service training, and professional development; the Records Division; Technology Information Group; and the Strategic Services Division, which provides research, data analysis, and reporting. These functions, while less visible to the public, are essential to maintaining bureau operations and are directly relevant to the staffing and cost analysis in this report, particularly the recruitment and training infrastructure discussed in later sections.

In addition to the work assigned within each branch, sworn personnel across the bureau carry shared responsibilities that consume a significant portion of available time, including court appearances, warrant service, report writing, mandatory training hours, off-duty time, and administrative leave associated with use-of-force reviews and other internal processes.

## Bureau Budget

The Portland Police Bureau currently has 877 authorized sworn positions[6] and 342 authorized non-sworn positions, for a total of 1,219 authorized positions. Total vacancies across the bureau hover around 10%, though the vacancy rate fluctuates considerably over the course of a year as recruitment classes and retirement cycles create uneven patterns of hiring and separation.

It is important to note that the bureau could not currently afford to fill all its authorized positions simultaneously. Of the bureau's approximately $320 million total budget, an estimated $11.7 million in personnel costs associated with roughly 89 positions is currently unfunded — meaning these positions are authorized but cannot be filled within the bureau's existing appropriation while maintaining the same levels of overtime. Vacancy savings from these and other unfilled positions have historically been used to fund a portion of the bureau's overtime budget, a practice driven in part by the nearly two-year gap between when an officer is hired and when that officer completes probation and can be deployed independently. In addition, rising costs for internal materials and services, inflationary pressure on external contracts, programmatic decisions, and labor contract costs exceeding initial estimates have contributed to this structural deficit within the bureau's operating budget. Closing that gap is beyond the scope of this report. The cost projections and staffing scenarios presented here assume that the financial resources necessary to support bureau growth would be made available, and that any expansion would require dedicated funding beyond the bureau's current appropriation.

[6] Source: 20260430 PPB Super Roster.xlsx

## Programmatic workload and Strategic Plan

The largest components of the programmatic workload of the police bureau are 911/non-emergency calls for service, self-initiated patrol activity, criminal investigations, crime prevention missions, community engagement/public events, and administrative support and training.

Chief Day has framed his key goals in terms of three primary elements:

- Transforming the dynamic between police and the people we serve.
- Reducing crime and the fear of crime.
- Organizational growth and development.

PPB has numerous actions assigned to it within the PSSA strategic plan that represent the work of key programs and initiatives of the bureau. These actions directly support PPB and the service area's ability to achieve the goals and objectives that employees and community members developed for public safety under the vision of 'a safe Portland for all'.

The first shared goal of the service area that PPB supports with its programming is the improvement of public safety response capabilities. To achieve this goal, the service area and PPB pursue the objective of identifying and developing culturally and situationally appropriate response strategies. PPB's work in this area involves implementing the public safety support specialist (PS3) strategic roadmap, which focuses on developing the PS3 program, including key performance indicators, standard operating procedures, annual training, and a dispatch protocol. The PS3 program aims to assist and engage with the community while reducing the instance of armed officers responding to non-emergency calls for service.

In addition to the PS3 program, PPB's Operations Division deploys Neighborhood Response Teams (NRTs) to collaborate and coordinate directly with community members, businesses, and city partners to address crime and disorder concerns. NRTs attend community meetings to hear concerns, corroborate concerns and the scope of issues, and then use this input to inform crime reduction missions. Programming like the PS3 and NRT programs support public safety's ability to provide a range of response options to the community and focus resources in a more tailored way.

Another key objective contributing to the service area's progress on improving public safety response capabilities is the measurement, evaluation, and improvement of public safety response performance and outcomes. PPB has several focus areas under this objective. The first is the initiative being led by the bureau's Equity and Inclusion Team to advance the bureau's work on the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) Title II relating to

nondiscrimination on the basis of disability, which includes implementing the results of a bureau Title II needs assessment and establishing a process for tracking ADA requests and outcomes.

PPB's second focus area under this objective is the Investigations Division's work on improving the tracking of case clearance, including development of standardized definitions and criteria for case status, training, reports to monitor clearance rates, and, once these internal tools and processes are in place, the establishment and tracking of clearance rate goals.

The third focus area for the bureau, led by the Operations Division, is conducting data-driven crime reduction missions, which includes training for personnel on data-driven strategies and planning, developing measurable targets, and evaluating mission effectiveness.

The fourth focus area, also led by Operations, is on reducing violent crime and property crime via improved response timeliness, improved report-writing, and increased assignment and clearance of investigations and follow-on patrol.

The fifth focus area, which also falls under Operations, is establishing response time goals for priority calls.

The final focus area under this objective, led by the Investigations Division, is improving investigations, including updating the standard operating procedure for case assignment and building a plan for improved capacity to handle additional types of crime, a greater number of cases, and improved solve rates. These focus areas collectively support the continuous improvement of the service area's response capabilities.

The service area's fourth objective under its first shared goal is improving coordination for response to major events. Led by the Specialized Resources Division, PPB supports this objective by focusing on developing all-hazard incident management teams that are interoperable with other city bureaus, integrating PPB's response to significant events into a larger citywide planning and coordination framework, updating PPB's emergency operations and continuity plans, and training and maintaining a specialized rapid response team for large-scale incidents that complies with Department of Justice guidance. This work supports the City's ability to prepare for, coordinate, and respond to major events ranging from the Rose Festival to a natural disaster.

Public Safety's second shared goal is the enhancement of collaboration internally, with partner agencies, and with the community. PPB currently has four focus areas in support of this goal. Led by the Services Branch and the Equity and Inclusion Team, the first two focus areas are expanding PPB's outreach programs for youth and communities affected by crime

and police by partnering with schools, youth organizations, and culturally-specific groups to build relationships and increase understanding between officers and community members. Thirdly, PPB is focused on developing its Community Engagement Liaison Program by onboarding 40-50 members as community engagement liaison officers to support events, meetings, and community initiatives. PPB's fourth focus area is on increasing officer foot patrols (also referred to as walking beats) to engage community members and businesses.

The Public Safety Service Area's third shared goal is to increase focus on the overall wellbeing of the public safety workforce and system. Under this goal, the PPB Training Division focuses on enhancing the physical, mental, emotional, social, and financial health of bureau employees via an annual wellness survey and report. This team also focuses on developing an annual training plan for the bureau and delivering the identified trainings each year.

The service area's fourth and final shared goal is the strengthening of prevention, recovery, and resilience capabilities. Under this umbrella, PPB focuses on collaborating with transportation agencies on Vision Zero initiatives to reduce and prevent traffic deaths and make streets safer. PPB's Traffic Unit works to reduce fatal crashes by stopping and arresting impaired drivers, collaborates with the District Attorney's Office to ensure cases are sound and able to be prosecuted, provides continuing education to officers on the most recent impaired driving case law, and participates in the Metro Area Traffic Enforcement Collaboration (MATEC) to conduct holiday DUII enforcement missions, as well as working on other projects, including but not limited to public information and education and working with PBOT on photo radar camera installations.

To support community resilience, PPB's Specialized Resources Division works with PBEM to disseminate emergency preparedness information and hold public safety workshops and drills for community members. To support recovery for the community, this division also focuses on integrating PPB into citywide disaster recovery planning, which includes developing protocols for PPB's role in post-disaster operations (assisting in damage assessments and maintaining public order) and training officers to collaborate with emergency management and community organizations. To support recovery for individuals, PPB's team of victim advocates focuses on providing victim-centered and trauma-informed services that also address cultural and language needs.

The community engagement conducted during the development of the PSSA strategic plan also indicated the need to focus additional resources on East Portland, with particular emphasis on investigating and reducing human trafficking and supporting non-carceral interventions for sex workers. PPB's Human Trafficking Unit has developed a proposal on this

topic that has been approved by the DCA. Integration into the strategic plan is awaiting this spring's budget decisions.

## Section 3: Future workload for the Police Bureau

### Performance outcomes and current staffing gaps

The most effective approach to identifying appropriate staffing levels for a police bureau is one grounded in workload that is tied to identifiable outputs and measurable outcomes. A staffing target that is not connected to performance expectations is, at best, arbitrary. Before asking how many officers the bureau needs, the more fundamental question is: what do we expect those officers to achieve, and where are current staffing levels falling short of those expectations?

This section outlines the key performance areas most directly affected by sworn staffing levels, describes how PPB is currently performing against those measures, and identifies areas where resource constraints have created significant gaps between the bureau's capacity and the community's needs.

### Calls for service, and response times

The City of Portland has measured police response times for years. Since 2018 dispatched calls for service for PPB have fallen by 31% for high priority, 18% for medium priority, and 3% for low priority.

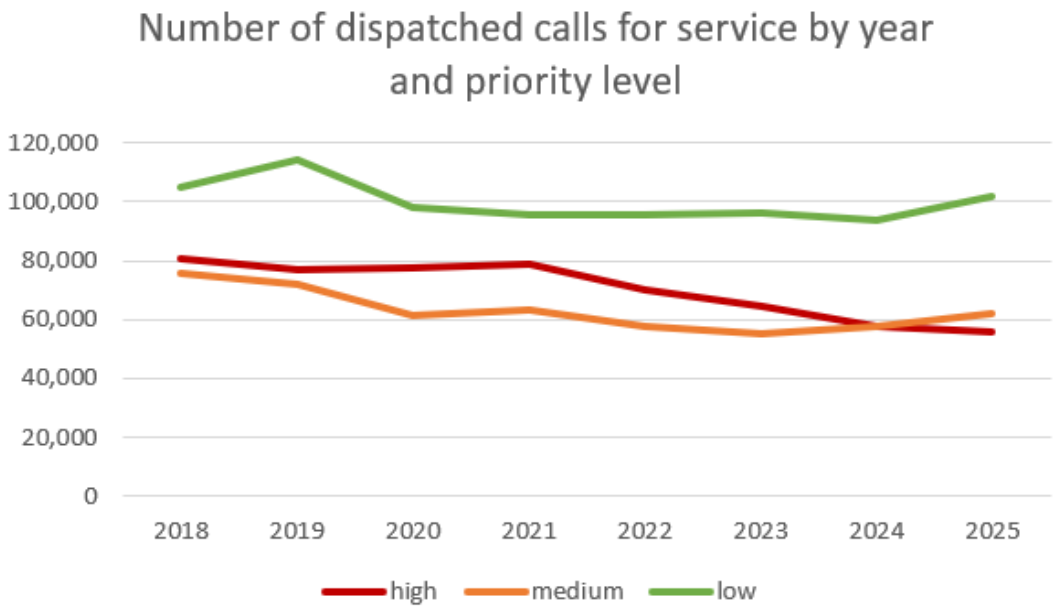



*Figure 1- Number of PPB dispatched calls for service by year and priority level.*

Over the same period average response time for high, medium, and low priority police 911 response has consistently increased over the past 8 years, doubling for highest priority, and increasing by 2.6 for medium priority.

In 2023 an estimated 13,940 calls that would have gone to PPB were responded to by PSR, and in 2024 this number was 12,100[7]. Data for 2025 is not yet available. This number is expected to rise as PSR expands its coverage and will more than double (to a volume equivalent to about 10% of PPBs annual dispatches) if the recommendations of the welfare checks working group are fully implemented.

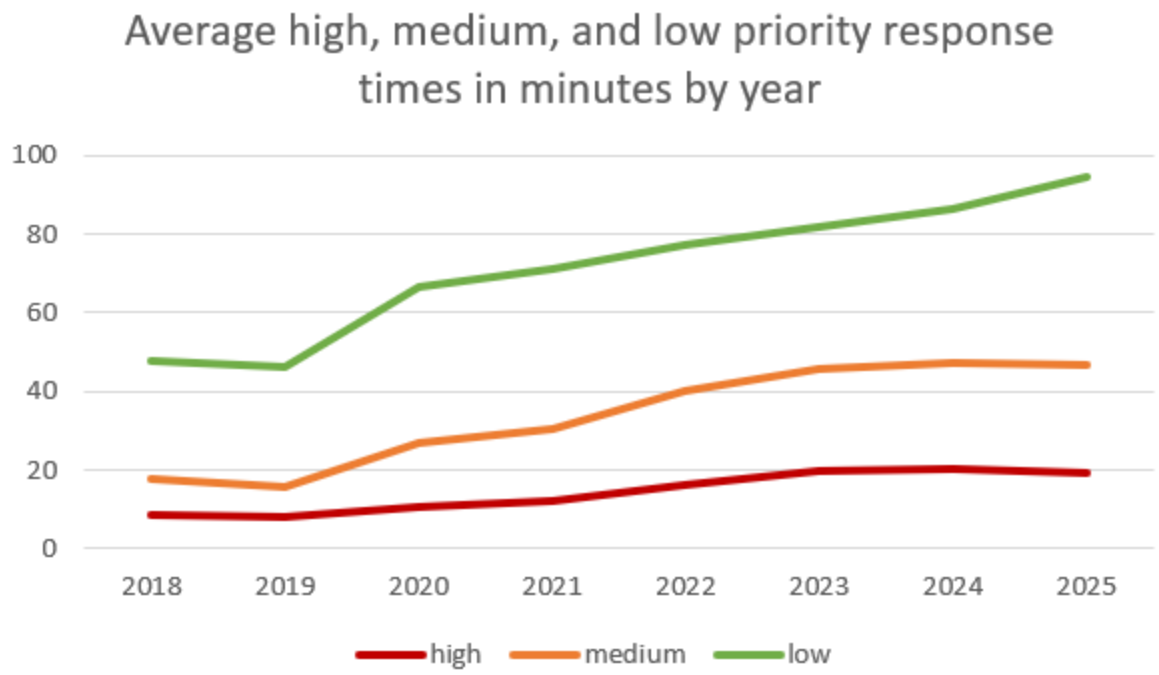



*Figure 2 - PPB average response times for high, medium, and low priority calls.*

## Priority response times

This metric tracks the elapsed time between dispatch from a 911 call and the arrival of the first officer on scene. Response time is widely regarded as one of the most important performance measures for patrol operations. For high-priority calls, such as crimes in progress, assaults, or reports of an armed individual, a rapid response increases the likelihood that a crime will be interrupted, that a suspect will still be present, and that physical evidence will be preserved. These factors directly affect whether crimes are solved and whether community members experience their police bureau as reliable and responsive.

[7] In 2023 PS3s responded to 24,226 calls, in 2024 20,660, and in 2025 21,800, although much of the workload currently handled by PS3s would either receive no response or be directed to online reporting rather than be responded to by sworn officers if PS3s were not responding.

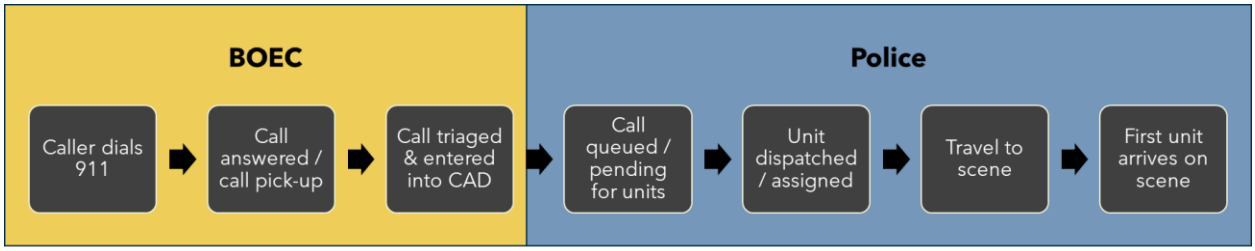



*Figure 3 - Stages of a call for service to PPB. PPB tracks the portion in blue, from when a call is queued in the PPB call system to when the first officer arrives on scene.*

Unlike fire and medical response, there is no nationally established standard for police response times to high-priority calls.[8] The Police Executive Research Forum (PERF),[9] the International Association of Chiefs of Police (IACP),[10] and the U.S. Department of Justice Community Oriented Policing Services (DOJ COPS)[11] all identify response time as a key performance metric. None set a specific target, recognizing that appropriate benchmarks will vary based on a jurisdiction's geography, call volume, staffing, and policy priorities.

The 1998-2000 Community Policing Strategic Plan that was adopted by City Council in June 1998 set a response time goal of 5 minutes to high priority calls (and also allocated 35% of officer available time for problem solving). A response time goal of seven minutes for high-priority calls was adopted in April 2026.

Prior to 2020, actual performance averaged between eight and ten minutes; above the target, but within a range that the bureau considered operationally manageable. That number has since increased dramatically. In the most recent fiscal year, average response time to high-priority calls was approximately 20 minutes[12]. There are many factors that contribute to this, including increased travel times, more complex or higher acuity calls requiring more officers, and fewer available patrol officers meaning longer wait times.

[8] Academic discourse on the idea of response times has been divided, with some authors claiming that unless police can respond within the first minute or so (which they cannot) response times do not matter, while more recently the idea that for certain types of situations rapid response makes a big difference. In either case however, there is broad agreement that public trust in police is greatly affected by priority response times. Response speed is highly predictive of victim evaluations of police, and is also predictive of crime clearance likelihood. Increasing response times also predicts greater likelihood of an injury, especially among women victims. https://www.crimrxiv.com/pub/02md8eqk/release/1

[9] https://www.policeforum.org/

[10] IACP documents support the idea that agencies should develop agency-specific performance objectives including response time, but the actual numeric values are locally determined, not mandated by IACP

[11] DOJ/COPS asserts that there is a professional expectation that response times be defined and measured, with performance objectives set based on agency workload and community expectations.

[12] Source: 2025 03 31 - PPB Data for Mayor.xlsx

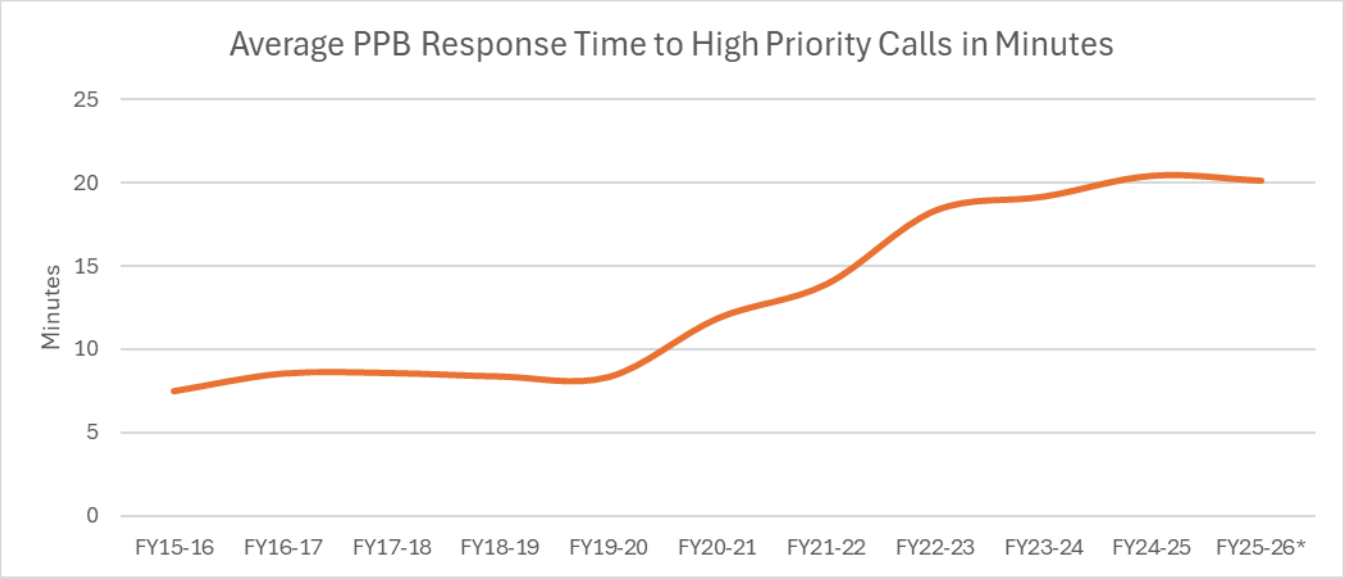



*Figure 4 - Average Response time (from call being placed in queue to first unit on scene) for PPB for the past ten years (Partial year response time data for FY25-26 through March 2026). Response times have increased by 2.7 times from their low of 7.5 minutes in FY15-16 to their high of 20.4 minutes in FY24-25.*

This deterioration has direct consequences. Longer response times mean officers are less likely to arrive while a crime is still in progress, reducing the chance of apprehension and increasing the risk of harm to victims. They also erode public confidence in the reliability of the 911 system and can discourage community members from reporting crimes at all.

Setting a clear, publicly stated response time target serves several purposes in the context of this report. It provides a benchmark against which current performance can be measured, it allows the City to estimate the number of patrol officers required to meet that target, and it creates a framework for discussing tradeoffs. Since the primary way to reduce response times (aside from reducing call volume through a reduction in crime or the percentage of calls diverted to alternative responders) is to increase the number of officers assigned to patrol, a defined target would prompt a necessary conversation about whether the City prioritizes faster response over other potential uses of available officers, or whether some combination of both can be achieved at a given staffing level.

## Officer-initiated calls

In recent years the percentage of officer-initiated calls has been in the 21-23% range. Officers being able to spend a greater percentage of patrol time on self-initiated activities is indicative of a situation with more community and proactive policing, rather than a focus on more reactive work in response to calls.

## Investigative clearance rates

Clearance rates (the proportion of reported crimes that result in an arrest or other resolution) are a key measure of investigative effectiveness. Homicide clearance rates[13] are particularly significant, both as an indicator of the bureau's capacity to solve the most serious crimes and as a component of the City's broader violence reduction strategy.

Portland's Ceasefire program, a nationally recognized strategy for reducing shootings and homicides, rests on a framework of prevention, intervention, and enforcement. A core element of that framework is the message that gun violence will be met with swift and certain consequences. High homicide clearance rates make that message credible[14]. When cases are solved, witnesses are more willing to cooperate, and individuals involved in group violence adjust their behavior based on the perceived risk of arrest. Conversely, when clearance rates are low, the deterrent effect weakens and individuals engaged in violence learn that the likelihood of being held accountable is limited.

While clearance rates are not a perfect metric and should not be evaluated in isolation, they are critical to assessing whether the City's investigative resources are aligned with its stated public safety priorities. If the City identifies gun violence reduction as a top priority, then the capacity to investigate and solve shootings must be sufficient to support that strategy.

It is also worth noting that response time and investigative capacity can compete for the same pool of sworn personnel[15]. Assigning more officers to patrol to improve response times may come at the expense of the detective and investigative units that drive clearance rates, and vice versa. This tension is inherent in any staffing discussion and underscores the need for council and the community to articulate clear priorities that can guide how a given number of officers are allocated across functions.

## Additional areas needing investigative capacity

Beyond the high-profile metrics of response time and homicide clearance, current staffing constraints have forced the bureau to make difficult triage decisions across a range of investigative areas. In each case, the severity of the crimes involved and the vulnerability of the victims make these gaps particularly consequential. Systematic data on the rate at which different types of reports are assigned for investigation, what the target rates for referral are, and clearance rates for these investigations were not available in time for the finalization of this report.

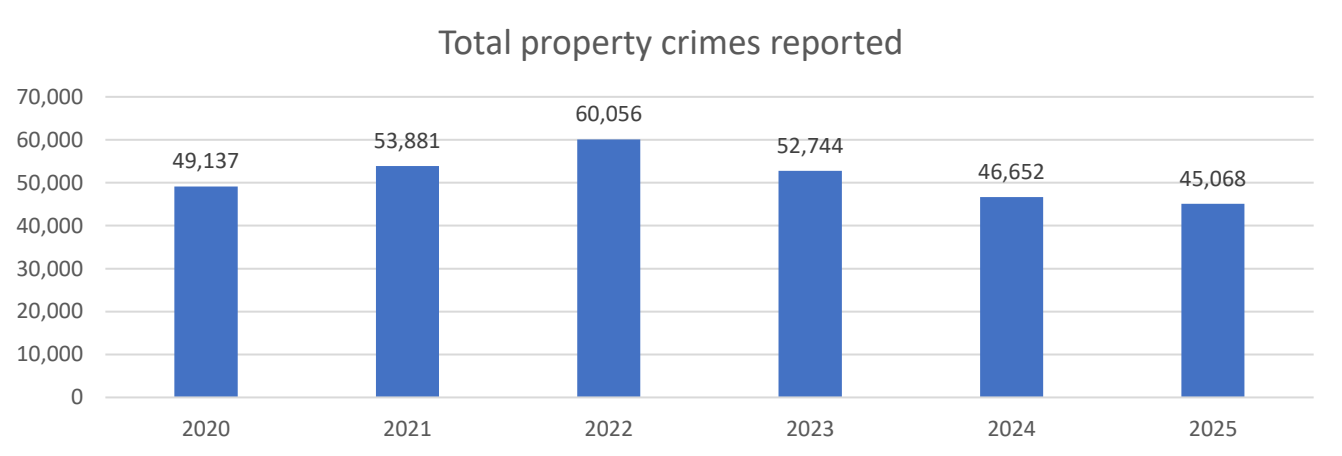
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[13] In FY 23/24 (the most recent year available) PPB's homicide clearance rate was 65%.
[14] Work is also underway to track prosecution and conviction rates for homicides.
[15] Bearing in mind that the initial stage of investigation is carried out by patrol officers.

**Child abuse:** The bureau currently lacks the investigative capacity to follow up on the majority of child abuse tips it receives. Approximately 80% of incoming tips do not receive an assigned investigator. While not every tip will ultimately involve criminal conduct warranting a full investigation, the current threshold means that a significant volume of reports involving potential harm to children receive no investigative follow-up at all; a gap that bureau leadership has identified as unacceptable given the severity and vulnerability involved.

**Domestic violence:** Domestic violence cases involve recurring patterns of harm, escalation risk, and significant danger to victims. Investigative capacity constraints limit the bureau's ability to build cases that go beyond initial patrol response, potentially leaving victims without the sustained follow-up necessary to support prosecution and long-term safety. Domestic violence is a leading cause of violent victimization, accounting for more than 40% of homicides in Multnomah County.[16]

**Property crime:** Property crimes (including burglary, theft, and vehicle theft) represent a high volume of reported offenses and are among the most visible public safety concerns for many Portland residents. At current staffing levels, the vast majority of property crimes receive limited or no investigative follow-up beyond the initial report.




**Elder fraud and white-collar crime:** Financial crimes targeting seniors and other complex fraud cases require specialized investigative skills and sustained case development. These cases are often deprioritized relative to violent crime, but they can involve significant financial and emotional harm to victims who are among the community's most vulnerable.

In each of these areas, the bureau faces a fundamental question of triage. Not every reported crime can or should receive the same level of investigative resources. The severity of the offense, the vulnerability of the victim, the likelihood of successful resolution, and the

[16] https://multco.us/file/25047a-25_proposed.pdf/download

broader public safety impact all factor into how limited investigative capacity is allocated. For the most serious offenses, such as homicide, the expectation is that every case receives a thorough investigation regardless of resource constraints. For other categories, the question is where to set the threshold and current staffing levels have pushed those thresholds to a point where significant categories of harm are going largely unaddressed. Determining what investigative capacity the community expects the bureau to maintain across these areas is an essential input into any staffing plan.

### Overtime reliance

Current staffing levels have led to significant reliance on overtime to maintain basic operational coverage[17]. Reducing that reliance is a priority for the bureau for two reasons. First, overtime carries a substantial cost premium over regular compensation, and sustained overtime spending represents an inefficient use of limited resources. Second, chronic overtime contributes to fatigue, burnout, and diminished wellbeing among sworn personnel: outcomes that are at odds with the workforce sustainability goals outlined in the Public Safety Service Area's strategic plan and that can negatively affect both officer performance and long-term retention.

[17] Source: https://public.tableau.com/app/profile/portlandpolicebureau/viz/OvertimeDashboard-public/OTHoursbyMonth

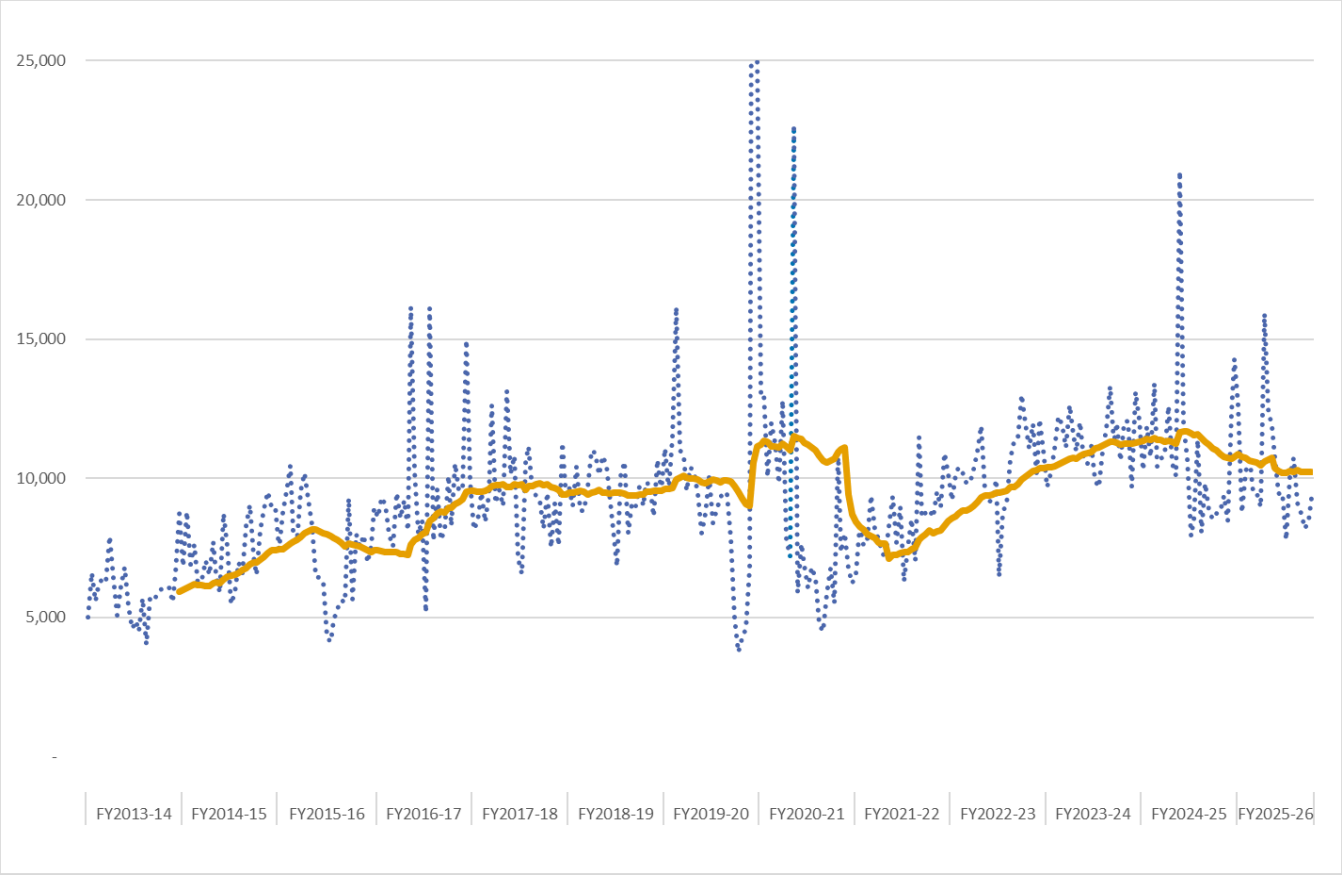



*Figure 5 - This chart shows the total overtime hours within PPB per pay period by Fiscal Year in blue, with a one year moving average in orange. (With outlier of 50k hours in June of 2020 off the chart). The moving average has increased from 5,917 in FY2014 to a high of 11,318 in FY2024.*

## Community and proactive patrol

The bureau has identified a need to increase the amount of time officers spend on proactive patrol and community engagement. The majority of patrol officers' time is currently consumed by responding to dispatched calls, leaving limited capacity for the kind of visible, relationship-building presence in neighborhoods that is central to community policing. Proactive patrol, including foot patrols, engagement with business owners, the general public, attendance at community events, and informal relationship-building, is an important complement to reactive response work. It contributes to crime prevention, strengthens public trust, provides a respite from higher acuity calls which can contribute to wellness, and supports the goals around community engagement articulated in both the PSSA strategic plan and the Council resolution that directed this report.

## Areas where PPB work could expand

City Code Section 3.20.110 defines the duties of the Portland police force broadly to "*preserve the public peace, prevent crime, arrest offenders, protect rights of persons and property, guard the public health, preserve order, and generally obey and enforce all*

*ordinances of the City Council and criminal laws of the State and of the United States*." This mandate is expansive, and the bureau's actual scope of operations at any given time reflects both the breadth of that charge and the practical constraints of available staffing.

Some categories of work the bureau will almost certainly continue to perform over the next ten years regardless of staffing levels. These include response to high-priority calls where people or property are in immediate danger, criminal investigations, arrest and detention, and the core patrol functions that underpin the 911 system. The question for staffing purposes is not whether the bureau will do this work, but how well and what additional functions it could take on or restore if staffing levels permitted.

The following areas represent significant gaps between the bureau's current capacity and the scope of work its leadership has identified as important to fulfilling its public safety mission.

### Patrol staffing and response capacity

As discussed in the performance outcomes section of this report, current patrol staffing levels have resulted in average high-priority response times of approximately 20 minutes - well above the bureau's seven-minute target. Increasing the number of officers assigned to patrol would reduce response times and increase the number of calls that can be responded to in a given shift. It would also reduce the bureau's reliance on overtime to maintain minimum staffing levels, with corresponding benefits for both cost efficiency and workforce wellbeing.

The bureau currently operates three precincts (Central, East, and North) covering approximately 145 square miles. Public Safety Service Area leadership has identified a four-precinct model as a potential strategy for improving service delivery and geographic coverage. Moving to a fourth precinct would require additional command staff, patrol officers, administrative support, and potentially a new or renovated physical facility. While detailed planning for this transition has not been completed, it represents a significant potential expansion of organizational capacity that would need to be reflected in any long-range staffing plan. The bureau would increase Precinct Patrol from 588 if there were a 50% increase in sworn personnel.

### Investigative capacity

The performance outcomes section of this report identifies several areas where investigative staffing falls short of the bureau's needs and the community's expectations. Increasing the number of detectives and other investigative personnel could expand the range of reported crimes that receive investigative follow-up (including child abuse cases, domestic violence, property crime, and elder fraud) and could improve clearance rates for the cases that are

assigned. It is worth noting that the bureau currently calculates clearance rates only for incidents that are assigned for investigation; crimes that never receive an investigator are not reflected in clearance statistics, meaning the reported clearance rate understates the true gap between reported crime and investigative resolution.

It is important to note that investigative capacity is dependent on the quality of the initial patrol response. Detectives and investigative units build their cases on the foundation established by the first officers on scene, including the statements gathered, evidence preserved, witnesses identified, and documentation completed during the initial response. If patrol staffing is insufficient to allow officers to conduct thorough preliminary investigations, the cases that reach detectives will arrive with weaker evidentiary foundations, reducing the likelihood of successful resolution regardless of how many investigators are assigned. Increasing detective staffing without maintaining or increasing the patrol officer positions that generate, and support investigative work would be counterproductive. Any expansion of investigative capacity should be pursued in coordination with, not at the expense of, adequate patrol staffing. The bureau would increase the capacity from 98 to 135 in the Detectives Division if there were a 50% increase in sworn personnel.

### Traffic enforcement

In 2021, the bureau disbanded its dedicated Traffic Division so that those officers could be reassigned to 911 response and patrol duties. The division was partially reconstituted in 2023 with two sergeants and approximately 12 officers providing traffic enforcement primarily during afternoon and evening hours. While the City has expanded the use of automated enforcement cameras and the bureau conducts targeted traffic safety missions on an overtime basis, the current staffing level represents a fraction of the division's previous capacity.

The City of Portland is committed to eliminating traffic deaths and serious injuries on our streets. Increasing the number of officers assigned to the Traffic Division could strengthen the bureau's contribution to the City's Vision Zero commitment by expanding the hours and geographic reach of traffic enforcement and increase the capacity for fatal and serious injury crash investigations and DUII enforcement.

### Specialty units and mission capacity

Current staffing constraints limit the bureau's ability to staff specialty units and conduct the data-driven enforcement missions that have been central to its crime reduction strategy. Many of these missions (including stolen vehicle operations, retail theft enforcement, narcotics suppression, and human trafficking investigations) are currently funded through overtime and grant dollars, an approach that is neither operationally sustainable nor fiscally efficient over the long term. Increasing overall staffing could allow more missions to be

conducted using on-duty personnel and could support the creation or expansion of specialty units in areas of growing need.

### Community engagement and proactive patrol

The bureau has identified a need to increase officers' capacity for proactive patrol and community engagement, including foot patrols (walking beats), bicycle patrols, attendance at community events, and sustained relationship-building with neighborhoods and business districts. PPB's 2024 holiday walking beat program, in which 223 members participated and recorded nearly 600 community engagements reaching over 5,000 individuals and businesses, demonstrated the value the public places on visible, non-enforcement police presence. Expanding this capacity on a sustained basis would require additional patrol staffing beyond what is needed to maintain minimum 911 response coverage.

### Victim support services

Victim advocates play a critical role in case outcomes. Survivors and witnesses who receive timely support are more likely to cooperate with investigations and participate in prosecution, directly affecting clearance rates and the accountability outcomes that the community expects. Increasing the number of victim support specialists would expand the bureau's capacity to provide these services across a broader range of case types, particularly in areas such as domestic violence, human trafficking, and crimes against children where victim engagement is essential to successful investigation and prosecution.

### School resource officers

Prior to 2020, the bureau maintained a School Resource Officer (SRO) program under an agreement with Portland Public Schools (PPS)[18], with planning for nine SROs and two supervising sergeants assigned to cover nine high school clusters. PPS ended its contract with PPB in June 2020, and the 14 sworn positions associated with the program were removed from the bureau's authorized staffing.[19] School safety functions are now handled through district security staff and community programs, including community safety associates assigned to each high school and middle school[20].

Bureau leadership continues to see value in school-based policing as a tool for relationship-building, early intervention, and youth safety. However, restoring the program would require

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[18] Portland maintained an independent school police department (Portland Public Schools Police) from 1937 until it was absorbed into the PPB in 1998.

[19] https://www.portland.gov/budget/2020-2021-budget/documents/fy-2020-21-adopted-budget-volume-3-program-offers/download

[20] In 2021-2022 Multnomah Education Service District (MESD) began a partnership with PPB, paying the salary of one liaison officer to work off-site. In 2023 a second officer was added to the program. https://katu.com/news/local/portland-city-council-approves-second-school-liaison-officer-for-multnomah-county-schools

renewed agreement with the school district, and the political and community dynamics surrounding school-based policing have shifted significantly since 2020. This report does not assume restoration of the SRO program in its staffing scenarios, but notes it as a potential future expansion that would carry additional personnel and cost implications if pursued.

### *Homeless outreach and liaison*

The bureau previously maintained a homeless liaison officer position, which has not been filled for several years. Several neighboring jurisdictions have dedicated personnel or units focused specifically on homelessness-related public safety and service coordination. Multnomah County's HOPE Team, for example, works to build relationships with vulnerable populations and connect them to housing and social services, responding to livability complaints with a service-oriented rather than purely enforcement-based approach. The City of Vancouver, Washington operates a HART model that combines outreach, sanitation assessment, service referrals, and community education with a structured interagency process for managing encampments. Reinstating a dedicated liaison or outreach function within PPB could improve coordination with the City's broader homelessness response system and provide a consistent point of contact for community members, service providers, and other City bureaus working on these issues.

### *Non-sworn programs*

Most of the programmatic and operational work of the Portland Police Bureau is performed by sworn personnel. However, approximately one-third of the bureau's authorized workforce is non-sworn. These civilian staff members perform functions that are essential to the bureau's operations and that would be directly affected by any significant change in the size of the sworn workforce.

The larger non-sworn units include the Strategic Services Division, which provides research, data analysis, and statistical reporting for the bureau; Professional Standards, which conducts administrative investigations and supports internal accountability processes; the Property and Evidence Division, which stores and manages all property, evidence, and contraband that comes into the bureau's possession; the Records Division, whose specialists process hundreds of police reports daily to ensure compliance with crime reporting standards, provide public-facing customer service, and respond to public records requests; and administrative support staff, including desk clerks and administrative support specialists assigned across the bureau's precincts and divisions. The Public Safety Support Specialist (PS3) program, discussed elsewhere in this report, also falls within the non-sworn workforce.

The relationship between sworn staffing levels and non-sworn staffing needs is not one-to-one, but it is real. Some non-sworn functions, such as records processing and evidence

management, scale roughly with the volume of the bureau's operational activity and would require additional capacity as sworn staffing and case volume grow. Others would increase in stepwise fashion tied to organizational changes: opening a new precinct, for example, would require additional desk clerks, administrative support, and facilities staff. Any staffing plan that contemplates significant sworn growth should account for the corresponding non-sworn positions that would be needed to support that expansion.

The table below shows one example distribution of additional staffing capacity.[21] Any significant increase in sworn personnel would require some increase in non-sworn personnel to provide support.

| | Current | Expanded | % Growth |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Chief's Branch** | | | |
| CHO/CIU/PIO/OIG/IOPS | 20 | 20 | 0% |
| Comm Engagement/BHU/SRO | 15 | 46 | 207% |
| Prof Standards Div | 8 | 8 | 0% |
| **Operations Branch** | | | |
| Central Precinct | 150 | 161 | 7% |
| East Precinct | 132 | 151 | 14% |
| North Precinct | 129 | 138 | 7% |
| Precinct No. 4 | 0 | 138 | NA |
| Ops Support/Traffic/Transit | 6 | 96 | 1500% |
| **Investigations Branch** | | | |
| Detective Division | 98 | 135 | 38% |
| Family Serv/Cares NW | 0 | 1 | NA |
| Forensic Evidence Div | 14 | 28 | 100% |
| Specialized Resources Div | 115 | 115 | 0% |
| **Services Branch** | | | |
| Personnel Division | 7 | 7 | 0% |
| Training Division | 46 | 48 | 4% |
| **TOTALS** | 740 | 1092 | 48% |

*Figure 7: In 2025 the bureau developed a model of where they would place additional sworn personnel if their filled positions were approximately 350 above the current levels of working, non-trainee, employees.*

[21] 20260430 PPB Super Roster.xlsx

### Other functions performed by police departments elsewhere

Some police departments perform functions that in Portland are handled by other agencies or are not currently part of the bureau's operations. These include parking enforcement (managed in Portland by the Bureau of Transportation), jail and detention operations (operated by Multnomah County), marine patrol (provided by Multnomah County, Oregon State Police, and the U.S. Coast Guard), airport policing (handled by the Port of Portland Police Department), ambulance or paramedic services, and disaster response, rescue services, and civil defense operations. Transit policing is shared in Portland through the TriMet Transit Police Department, which includes officers from several agencies, including PPB officers on assignment. The bureau also previously operated an equine unit, which was disbanded in 2017 for budgetary reasons. None of these functions are assumed as part of the staffing scenarios in this report.

### Summary of potential expansion

The areas of potential expansion described above are not presented as recommendations, but as a landscape of unmet needs and organizational gaps that the bureau and City leadership have identified. Each would carry staffing and cost implications that are reflected, to varying degrees, in the scenarios presented later in this report. Importantly, none of these expansions could be implemented overnight. Any future restructuring would depend on sustained public input, stable and predictable funding, and hiring rates sufficient to support growth beyond current baseline needs. A realistic path forward would involve phased progression from the bureau's current organizational structure toward a proposed end state, with decision points along the way that allow Council and the community to evaluate progress, reassess priorities, and adjust course as conditions warrant.

## Areas where PPB work could decrease

In addition to changes in the size of the sworn workforce, the bureau's effective capacity can be influenced by how officer time is allocated and whether certain functions can be performed more efficiently or shifted to other providers. This section describes several categories of change - internal efficiencies, civilianization of sworn functions, and diversion of call types to other agencies - that could reduce the demands on sworn personnel and free officers to focus on work that requires their specialized training and authority.

### Internal efficiencies and technology

The bureau has made significant operational changes over the past two decades through the adoption of new technology. Report writing, once done by hand, is now digital. More recently, the bureau has encouraged members of the public to file reports for certain cold property crimes through an online reporting system rather than by phone or in person. This shift has reduced the time sworn officers and BOEC dispatchers spend on reports that do

not merit investigative follow-up, while also improving the speed and consistency of service for community members.

Additional opportunities for streamlining through digitization and process improvement likely exist. While the bureau has pursued some of these efficiencies on an ad hoc basis, a more systematic review could identify further areas where technology or workflow redesign could reduce the time sworn personnel spend on administrative tasks.

### Wellness time

One notable change affecting the allocation of officer time has been the introduction of wellness time. The bureau currently grants sworn members four hours of wellness time per week, a practice intended to support employee retention and wellbeing, and one that has been well received by staff. However, this represents approximately a 10% reduction in the hours each officer spends on direct work activities (although the benefit can be suspended in response to extraordinary demand). This practice has not been formally bargained with the applicable labor unions, and any modifications to the wellness program would likely need to be negotiated. For the purposes of this report, current wellness time allocations are assumed to continue; however, any staffing model should account for this reduction when calculating effective available hours per officer.

### Civilianization of sworn functions

Historically, the balance between work performed by sworn personnel and work performed by civilian staff has shifted over time. In some cases, tasks that were traditionally handled by sworn officers have been reassigned to civilian employees, freeing officers for duties that require law enforcement authority, training, or the ability to make arrests. Several current and potential examples illustrate this approach.

**Public safety support specialists (PS3s):** The PS3 program was created to enhance community engagement and reduce the number of armed officers responding to lower-priority situations. PS3s write reports for non-emergency incidents, respond to non-injury traffic collisions to facilitate information exchange, conduct follow-up on property crimes where there is no suspect information, and attend neighborhood meetings among other tasks. PS3s are not dispatched through 911 and operate under the supervision of patrol sergeants. Expanding the scope or staffing of this program could further reduce demands on sworn officers.

**Forensic criminalists:** The bureau's forensic evidence positions are currently filled by sworn personnel. Some comparable agencies staff these roles with civilian criminalists. Transitioning forensic positions to civilian classifications could free sworn positions for reassignment to patrol or investigative functions, potentially at a lower cost per position. This

change would require careful evaluation of any operational or legal requirements that necessitate sworn status for crime scene work.

**Administrative functions:** More broadly, periodic review of which administrative, analytical, and support functions are performed by sworn personnel versus civilian staff could identify additional opportunities for civilianization, allowing officers to be redeployed to duties that specifically require their training and authority.

### Diversion of call types to other providers

Perhaps the most significant potential reduction in PPB's workload comes from the ongoing and planned diversion of certain call types to other response providers. The 911 Call Allocation Working Group, which completed its recommendations in 2025 and 2026, identified several categories of calls that could be shifted away from PPB.

**Welfare checks and low-acuity calls to Portland Street Response:** The number of low-acuity calls PPB responds to has been declining as Portland Street Response has expanded its capacity. The Call Allocation Working Group's April 2026 recommendations include shifting approximately 14,000 welfare check calls from PPB to PSR over a period of approximately five years. These include calls that would already have been routed to PSR had a unit been available, calls involving pedestrians, wheelchair users, or bicyclists in roadways, calls involving a non-moving vehicle, medical welfare checks, unable-to-reach / needs-to-be-checked-on calls, and mental health crisis calls. The precise impact of diverting 14,000 calls on officer workload will depend on the average time currently spent on these call types, but the shift would meaningfully free patrol capacity for higher-priority response as well as potentially improving outcomes for the subjects of these calls.

**Unattended deaths:** PPB responded to 1,453 unattended death calls in the 2023–24 fiscal year, spending an average of 5 hours and 27 minutes per call, a total of approximately 7,900 hours of officer time annually, not including any subsequent reporting or follow-up. The Call Allocation Working Group found that the vast majority of these deaths are medical in nature rather than criminal, and recommended that the Medical Examiner's Office serve as the primary responding agency. Under this model, police would respond only when a criminal element is present or suspected, the scene is unsafe, the medical examiner requests support, or there is no person authorized under state law (ORS 146.10(6)) to take charge of the scene. Implementing this change would return a substantial block of officer hours to other duties.

**False alarms:** In 2024, PPB spent approximately 6,680 hours responding to alarm calls from community members and private alarm companies. Ninety-four percent of these calls were false alarms, meaning roughly 6,280 hours of officer time were consumed by responses that required no police action. The Call Allocation Working Group recommended several

changes: that PPB not respond to alarms from non-permitted systems, that PPB cease responding after a third false alarm from the same location within a year, that the bureau exercise its existing authority to fine repeat false-alarm offenders, and that officer discretion to waive these fines be eliminated. The group also recommended hiring a dedicated alarm coordinator to manage permit-holder education, ensure BOEC tracks alarm locations not eligible for response, and administer the fine process. The goal of these changes is to reduce false alarm responses to a negligible number, recovering a significant portion of the hours currently lost to them.

**Event management functions:** Certain public event and protest management functions, such as traffic control and intersection management during permitted events, may be candidates for transfer to civilian traffic control staff or contracted services, reducing the demand for sworn officers at events that do not present significant public safety risks. PPB has already begun experimenting with delegating some traffic management functions to event organizers rather than having PPB staff manage traffic.

**Behavioral health response:** PPB has maintained dedicated Behavioral Health Response Teams since FY 2012–13, pairing sworn officers with licensed mental health professionals. The bureau also operates the Enhanced Crisis Intervention Team (ECIT) and Service Coordination Team (SCT) programs. While these programs have been effective, they represent an approach in which the Police Bureau retains a significant role in behavioral health response. Many comparable jurisdictions have shifted some or all of this work to civilian-led or health-system-led models. As Portland Street Response continues to expand and the City evaluates the broader allocation of behavioral health response across agencies, the scope of PPB's direct role in this area may continue to evolve.

### Summary of potential decrease

Taken together, these changes represent a meaningful set of levers for increasing the effective capacity of the existing sworn workforce without hiring additional officers. They are not a substitute for addressing staffing shortfalls, but they are an important complement. Any staffing plan should account for both the current state of these initiatives and their projected trajectory, since the workload assumptions that underlie a staffing target will shift as these changes are implemented.

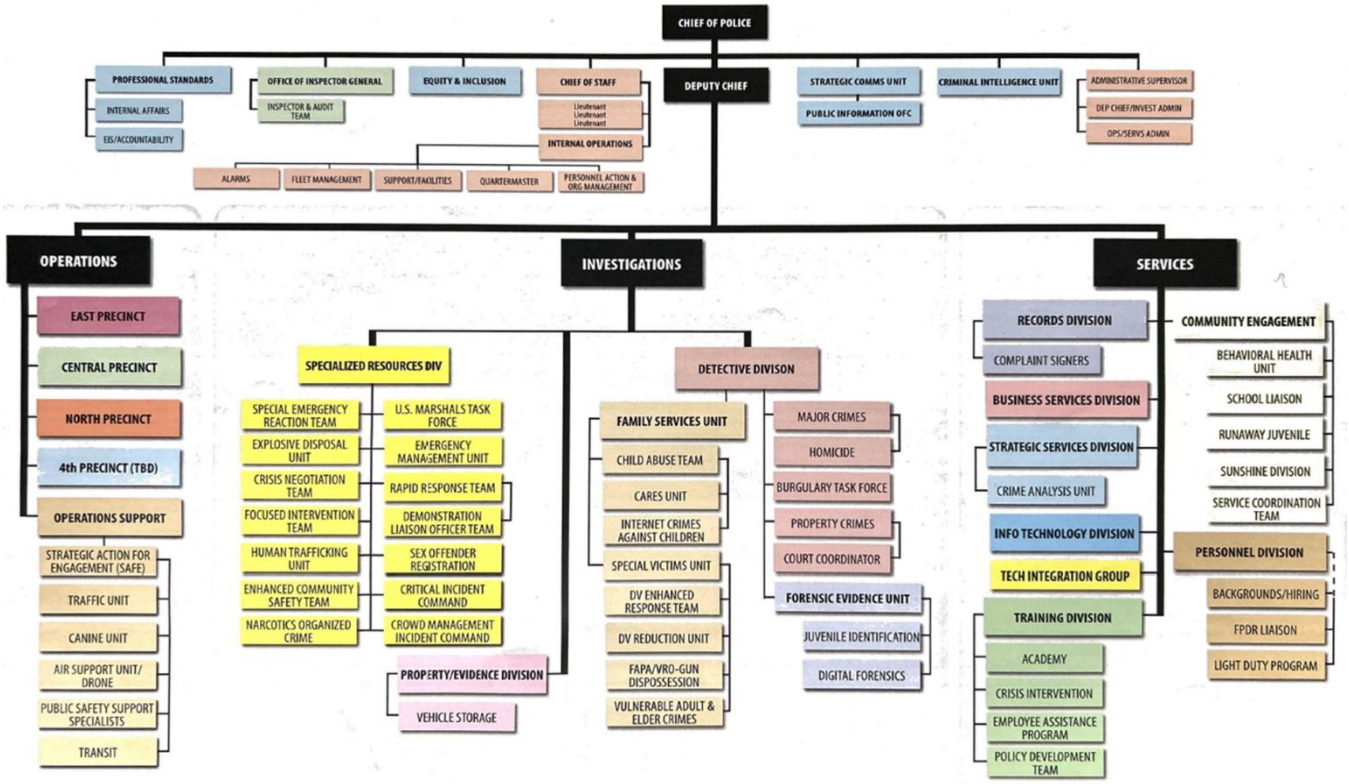



*Figure 8 - Example organizational chart for PPB with expanded programming from additional staff.*

## The role of crime rates and population trends in staffing projections

The staffing scenarios in this report are primarily driven by policy choices: what the City expects its police bureau to do, how quickly it wants to build capacity, and how much it is willing to invest. However, crime levels and population growth are external factors that also influence demand for police services.

Crime trends are shaped by forces largely beyond the control of any single police bureau, including national economic conditions, housing instability, substance use patterns, and changes in federal and state policy. At the same time, effective policing (through investigations, deterrence, and targeted enforcement) does influence crime outcomes. The relationship runs in both directions, and this report does not attempt to forecast future crime rates or model that relationship.

Population growth and urban development similarly affect the volume and complexity of police workload, but not in a simple or linear way. Two cities of the same size can have very different policing needs depending on geography, density, crime patterns, and the structure of their broader public safety systems. Consistent with Council direction, this report uses a workload-based methodology rather than a per-capita staffing ratio. The projected cost ratio

reflecting population growth and urban development over the next ten years, as directed by the Council resolution, is addressed in a later section.

## Section 4: Timeline and costs for increased recruitment

The preceding sections describe the bureau's current operations, the performance gaps created by existing staffing levels, and the range of ways in which the bureau's workload could expand or contract in the coming years. Together, they establish the context for the central question this report is designed to answer: given what the City expects its police bureau to do, what would it take to get there, how long would it take, and what would it cost?

The sections that follow turn from the question of what the bureau's staffing should achieve to the mechanics of how staffing levels actually change over time. They describe the key variables that drive staffing projections, present a range of scenarios based on different assumptions about hiring and retention, estimate the timeline for reaching various staffing levels, and detail the costs associated with each path.

### Staffing projections: Key variables and methodology

A range of factors must be considered when developing a staffing plan for the Portland Police Bureau. At its most basic, projecting future staffing levels is a matter of adding new hires and reducing separations from the current workforce. In practice, however, the calculation is considerably more complex. The Business Services Division has historically tracked seven key variables when modeling PPB staffing projections: trainee separations, officer separations, non-officer sworn separations, retirement timing, new hires, trainee probation completions, and officer promotions. These variables fall into three broad categories: separations, hiring, and internal movement.

#### *Separations*

Personnel leave PPB at different stages of their careers and for different reasons. Understanding these patterns is critical to projecting the net effect of recruitment efforts, since recruitment will only increase staffing levels if it outpaces total separations.

**Trainee separations:** It takes nearly two years for a new police officer to complete the full training and probation process. During that period, approximately 25% of trainees separate from PPB prior to completing probation. This includes both individuals who voluntarily leave (for example, those who determine the profession is not the right fit) and those who are separated by the bureau because they are determined to be unlikely to successfully complete training requirements.

The status quo for trainee separations has been fairly consistent over the past five years. To model best case scenarios we can take the State DPSST planning figure of average total police turnover of 10%. To model a worst-case scenario for separations, we could imagine a scenario where 50% of employees separate prior to completing their two-year training.

**Mid-career separations:** PPB also loses sworn personnel who are past their probationary period. These separations are tracked in two categories: officer separations and non-officer sworn separations (i.e., sergeants, detectives, and other ranks above officer). In a typical quarter, there are approximately four officer separations and two non-officer sworn separations, for a total of six. These departures reflect a range of circumstances including resignations, lateral transfers to other agencies, and terminations.

A number of conditions could lead to lower rates of voluntary separation among sworn personnel. Economic downturns have historically reduced attrition across law enforcement agencies, as fewer alternative employment opportunities are available. Future labor contract negotiations could introduce retention incentives such as bonuses, longevity pay, increased work/life balance measures, or enhanced benefits. Improvements in workplace culture and morale could also contribute to longer average tenures.

Exit interviews are voluntary, inconsistently completed, and information from them has not consistently led to actions being taken to prevent future separations. PPB's systematic collection of exit data through surveys ended in 2021following media reporting of data from the surveys[22]. Robust exit interviews have been shown to be able to reduce separations.

Recent history demonstrates how quickly retention conditions can deteriorate. Between July 2020 and July 2022, PPB's filled sworn positions fell from 936 to 768; a decline of over 18% in just two years. This period coincided with the COVID-19 pandemic and a series of racial justice protests that placed extraordinary pressure on police agencies nationwide. While these circumstances were exceptional, the episode illustrates that mid-career separation rates are highly sensitive to broader social, political, and economic conditions and can shift dramatically in a short period of time.

Even absent external disruptions, the composition of PPB's workforce is gradually shifting in ways that may increase baseline attrition over time. Officers hired since 2007 are enrolled in the Oregon Public Service Retirement Plan (OPSRP), a portable pension system administered through the state, rather than the City's Fire and Police Disability and Retirement (FPDR) fund. Unlike FPDR, which ties retirement benefits to service with the City of Portland, OPSRP benefits are portable across any participating public employer in Oregon. As OPSRP-enrolled officers make up an increasing share of the workforce, early data suggest that mid-career mobility is rising, whether to policing roles at other

[22] https://www.oregonlive.com/crime/2021/04/overworked-overwhelmed-and-burned-out-why-portland-cops-say-theyre-leaving-in-droves.html

jurisdictions or to career changes within other PERS-eligible public sector positions. This structural shift means that even maintaining current retention rates may require more active retention strategies than have historically been necessary.

For modeling best case scenarios, we model decreasing mid-career separations for a total of four separations per quarter. For modeling worst case scenarios, we would see mid-career separations increase for a total of eight per quarter.

**Retirements and the 27-pay period cycle:** Retirement timing among PPB personnel follows a distinct and predictable pattern driven by the structure of the City's pension system. Under the City Charter, retirement benefits for employees eligible for the Fire and Police Disability and Retirement (FPDR) fund are calculated based on earnings during the previous 12 months. Because the City operates on a biweekly payroll cycle, most 12-month periods contain 26 pay periods. However, periodically a 12-month lookback window will capture 27 pay periods rather than 26, resulting in a meaningfully higher pension calculation. As a result, Police and Fire personnel tend to cluster their retirements around these 27 pay period windows. Approximately 70% of total retirements occur during one of these lookback periods, producing spikes where 25 to 35 retirements may occur in a single month - compared to the typical baseline of roughly two retirements per month.

The City publishes the schedule of 27 pay period months in advance, and these spikes are accounted for in staffing projections. The most recent such period occurred in May 2026; the next occurs in October 2027. This phenomenon is tied to the FPDR retirement system; employees hired after 2006 are a part of the OPSRP system and will not have a similar incentive. In turn, these stepwise separations will fade starting in 2032 and retirements are expected to instead occur in a more even distribution throughout the year. These changes are reflected in the hiring model below.

Changes to retirement eligibility timelines, if pursued through future policy or bargaining, could extend career lifespans within the bureau, but not eliminate retirement separations.

### *Hiring*

In this analysis, hiring refers to any new sworn personnel added to PPB's workforce. While the bureau has the ability to hire lateral transfers (experienced officers from other agencies who enter at a mid-career level) the majority of sworn personnel are hired as entry-level officers and advance through the ranks over time.

PPB's hiring rate has varied considerably over the years depending on a number of factors, including the intensity of active recruitment efforts, advertising strategies, labor market conditions, authorization to hire, and the competitiveness of compensation relative to other

agencies. For the purpose of the projections in this report, the baseline assumption is that PPB sustains its current hiring rate of approximately 21 new officers per quarter. Later sections of this report examine what changes to recruitment capacity and investment would be required to accelerate that rate, and the associated costs.

Recent hires are considerably more diverse than employees that have been with the bureau for more than two decades. For example, sworn employees with 2-5 years of service are 64.9% white, compared to 86.7% of staff that have worked for the bureau for 21+ years[23]. Additional hiring has the opportunity to further diversify the workforce. Sworn personnel are predominantly male; the 30x30 Initiative presents an opportunity to diversify the workforce as well as expand recruitment possibilities.[24]

The primary constraint on PPB's current hiring rate is the volume of qualified applicants entering the recruitment pipeline. Several strategies could expand that pipeline over time. More intensive or sustained recruitment campaigns, including outreach to previously under-targeted populations (such as greater emphasis on recruiting women, multilingual candidates, or individuals from communities historically underrepresented in law enforcement) could broaden the applicant pool. Revisiting qualification or eligibility criteria could also affect the number of candidates who advance through the hiring process, though any such changes would need to be weighed carefully against training standards, the effect that changed criteria could have on graduation rates, and the expectations the community holds for its police officers.[25]

The bureau does not recruit in a vacuum. Other law enforcement agencies (local, state, and federal) compete for the same pool of candidates. For example, in the past year, Immigration and Customs Enforcement and other federal agencies have engaged in significant hiring campaigns that target a similar candidate profile to PPB's recruitment efforts. Shifts in the broader labor market, changes in the relative competitiveness of PPB's compensation package, or perceptions of instability in the bureau's funding or organizational direction could all reduce the number of qualified applicants choosing to pursue careers with PPB.

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[23] PPB workforce demographics dashboard - https://public.tableau.com/app/profile/portlandpolicebureau/viz/PPBEmployeeDemographics/DashboardBAR .

[24] About 30x30

[25] In the years following the COVID-19 Pandemic, one of the core bottlenecks for hiring staff within the PPB was the capacity for the state training academy to train new recruits. At times, PPB was hiring recruits to get them in the door, then assigning them to do administrative tasks for weeks or months while waiting to get them into some of the few academy seats. Since then, state capacity has increased so that it is not currently a barrier – though if hiring were to increase significantly, it could be again.

If the bureau were to increase its hiring rate, it would need to address several potential bottlenecks. In the past these have included the rate at which background checks can be completed, Oregon Department of Public Safety Standards and Training (DPSST)[26], physical space, trainers/coaching, buildings (precincts), vehicles, and vehicle garage facilities.

The status quo assumes the bureau will continue to meet the hiring rates the bureau is projected to meet in FY26: 21 new officers per quarter. In the past decade, the greatest number of officers hired was 100 a year; the best-case scenario would have the bureau besting that with 128 a year. The worst-case performance in hiring during the past decade was around 2020 when the bureau, like most of the City, was asked to stop hiring and brought in zero new officers. Given the assumption that financial limitations will not be a limiting factor, we use 12 per quarter.

### *Internal movement*

In addition to hiring and separations, staffing projections must account for internal movement within the sworn workforce. Two components are particularly important: the number of current employees who are trainees still completing probation, and the number of sworn personnel serving in non-officer ranks such as sergeant, detective, captain, and assistant chief.

Tracking these factors is essential because not all sworn personnel are available for patrol duty. Trainees are in various stages of the training process and are not yet independently deployable. Sworn personnel who have been promoted to supervisory or specialized roles serve critical functions but are not counted among the patrol officer workforce. Understanding the distribution of personnel across these categories allows for more accurate estimates of how many officers will be available for frontline patrol and response. Monitoring these internal movements is important for the metrics most directly connected to the response times, investigative capacity, and community presence that Council and the public are most concerned with. For the purpose of modeling total sworn staffing, this does not change the net number of sworn employees.

[26] The DPSST academy in Salem is the only state mandated training facility for upwards of 5,500 law enforcement officers in Oregon. Capacity is capped by the available dormitory space and scenario village buildings used for training. The State expanded the capacity of the facility to accommodate 260 trainees (up from 160) at once in 2023/24 reducing what was a 7 month wait to closer to 90 days. The State funds allow between 16-20 classes to run per biennium. 2.5% budget cuts are proposed in the 2025-27 cycle, compounding the fact that the facility was originally planned with a 10% officer turnover rate, not the ~25% currently statewide.

## Timeline for hiring

For the sake of these projections, we have made the assumption that the bureau would have adequate financial resources and would receive authorization for positions as needed.

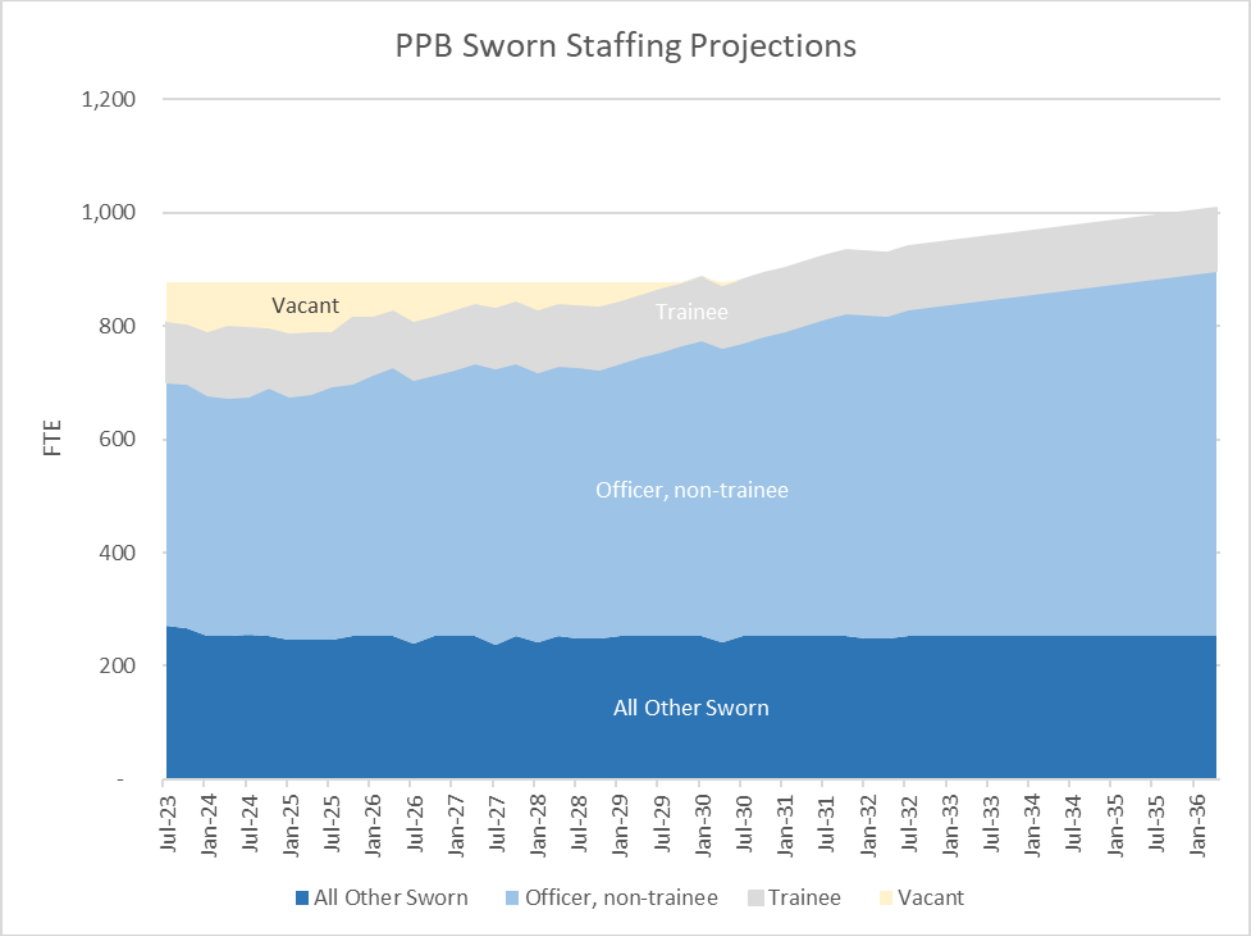



*Figure 9 - This chart shows the Sworn Staffing Projections for the Portland Police Bureau, using status quo assumptions and changes to net staffing. The bureau would exceed current authorized capacity in 2030 if all variables were to remain constant.*

The projections in this report are based on a baseline model that assumes current performance across each of the variables described above remains constant. Under that baseline, the model projects a net increase in sworn personnel of approximately 10%, from 799 filled positions in June 2024 to an estimated 870 filled positions by June 2029. This trajectory reflects the bureau's recent hiring momentum and accounts for expected separations, including the cyclical retirement spikes associated with 27 pay period lookback windows.

However, a five- to ten-year planning horizon introduces considerable uncertainty. Each of the variables that drive staffing projections is subject to change based on both internal policy decisions and external conditions beyond the City's control.

**Implications for long-range planning**

The range of potential outcomes underscores the importance of treating staffing projections as planning tools rather than firm commitments. A ten-year staffing forecast will inevitably require periodic revision as conditions evolve. The scenarios presented in this report attempt to account for this uncertainty by modeling a range of assumptions about hiring and retention rather than relying on a single projection.

| Inputs per quarter | Status quo | Worst-case | Best-case |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Avg Trainee Separations** | 4% | 8% | 2% |
| **Avg Sworn (non-officer) Separations** | 2 | 3 | 1 |
| **Avg Officer Separations** | 4 | 5 | 3 |
| **Retirement Estimate** | 26 | 26 | 26 |
| **Quarterly Hiring Target** | 21 | 12 | 32 |
| **Avg Trainee Probation Completion (per quarter)** | 15% | 15% | 15% |
| **Officer Promotions** | 2 | 2 | 2 |

*Figure 10 – Projections for status quo, best-case, and worst-case hiring scenarios*

The best-case and worst-case scenarios presented above are intended to illustrate the outer bounds of what is plausible, not to predict what will happen. In practice, the bureau is unlikely to sustain either extreme over a full decade.

Several of the variables that drive staffing projections are counter-cyclical, meaning that favorable movement in one variable can produce unfavorable movement in another. For example, one of the most straightforward strategies for increasing the hiring rate is to broaden eligibility criteria for applicants[27]. However, relaxing qualification standards would likely increase the percentage of trainees who separate during probation (either because they are unable to complete training requirements or because the profession proves to be a poor fit) partially offsetting the gains from a larger incoming class. Similarly, investments in retention through enhanced compensation or benefits reduce the rate of separations but increase the per-officer cost of sustaining the workforce, meaning that the fiscal savings from improved retention are real but not as large as the reduction in turnover alone would

[27] https://www.joinportlandpolice.com/entry-minimum-requirements

suggest. These dynamics mean that the most optimistic assumptions about hiring, retention, and trainee completion are unlikely to all materialize simultaneously.

The worst-case scenario is also unlikely to be sustained over a full decade. It would require a prolonged combination of adverse conditions (a severely constrained labor market, elevated mid-career separations, and a significant external disruption to recruitment or morale) persisting without any corrective action by the City or the bureau. While the 2020–2022 period demonstrated that such conditions can emerge, the bureau and City leadership would presumably respond with policy adjustments rather than allowing a multi-year decline to continue unchecked.

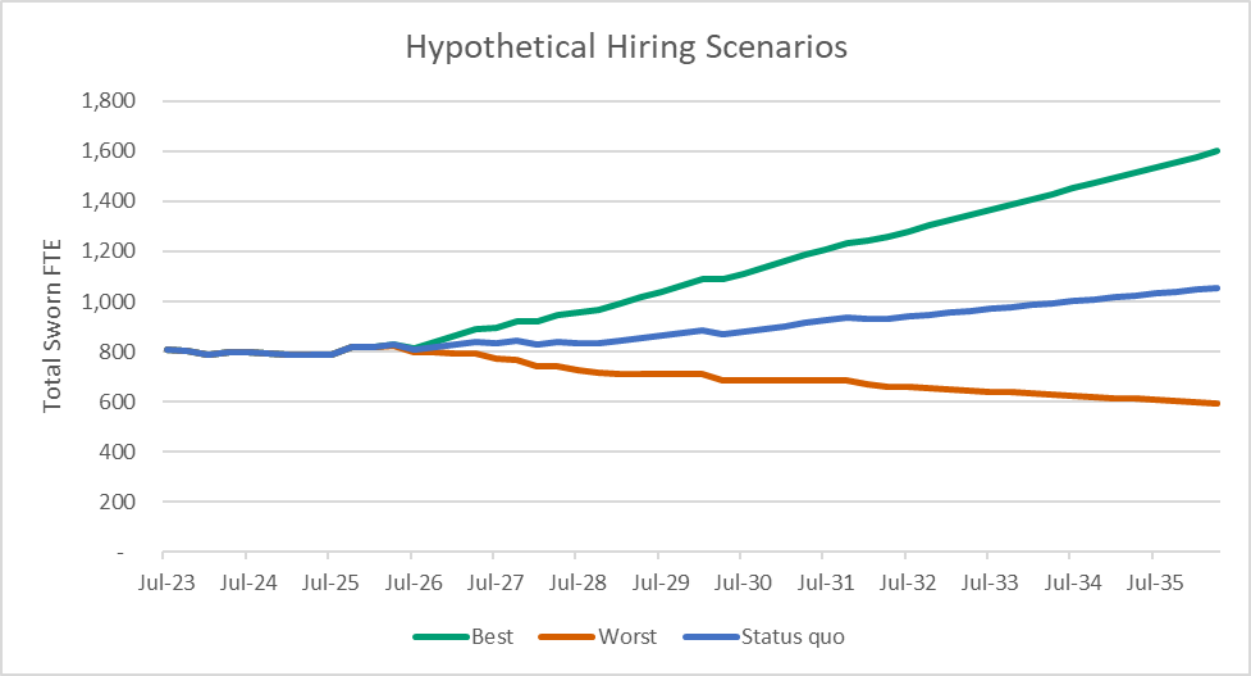



*Figure 11 - Divergence of hiring scenarios over a ten-year period, assuming each scenario remained constant and budget were not a limiting factor.*

In January 2026, the bureau had 816 sworn positions filled. The full range of modeled outcomes shows the bureau growing by as many as 884 sworn personnel over the next decade under the most favorable conditions, declining by approximately 120 under the most adverse conditions, or - under the status quo baseline - growing by approximately 340. In all likelihood, actual outcomes will fall somewhere within this range, with different variables performing favorably or unfavorably in different years rather than all moving in the same direction simultaneously.

It is also important to acknowledge that the confidence of any projection diminishes over time. Near-term projections (covering the next one to two years) are grounded in known

hiring pipelines, scheduled retirement windows, and current separation trends, and are therefore relatively reliable. Projections extending five or more years forward carry substantially greater uncertainty, as they are increasingly sensitive to economic conditions, labor market shifts, policy changes, and other factors that cannot be predicted with precision. This is consistent with the City's experience across all bureaus: staffing projections prepared as part of the annual budget cycle are regularly revised as conditions evolve. The scenario-based approach used in this report is designed to account for that uncertainty by presenting a range of possible outcomes rather than a single forecast.

For the purposes of the cost analysis that follows, we use the status quo baseline as the primary scenario and examine the fiscal implications of staffing growth at that rate. We also present the incremental costs associated with accelerating growth beyond the baseline. Specifically, what additional investment in recruitment, training, and organizational capacity would be required to achieve faster net increases in sworn staffing? This is so that council can evaluate the cost of different levels of ambition against the performance outcomes those staffing levels would be expected to produce.

## Cost projections

The staffing scenarios described in this report carry significant fiscal implications. The cost of increasing sworn staffing levels extends well beyond the salaries of the officers themselves. It includes recruitment, training, equipment, vehicles, ongoing personnel costs, and in some scenarios, major capital investment. At the same time, increased staffing can generate meaningful cost offsets, particularly through reductions in overtime spending and through the avoided costs of replacing officers who leave. This section outlines the major cost categories associated with changes in sworn staffing levels.

### *Costs of hiring and training new personnel*

The most significant near-term cost of expanding the sworn workforce is the investment required to bring each new officer through the hiring process and roughly two-year training and probation period. During this period, probationary employees represent a cost to the bureau without yet contributing to operational capacity — they are not independently deployable and require significant supervisory and training resources.

The estimated cost of bringing a single new officer through the probationary period includes the following components:

> **Salary and benefits during probation.** Each probationary officer costs approximately $301,000 in salary and benefits over the course of the training period.

**Advanced Academy.** In addition to the basic academy operated by the Oregon Department of Public Safety Standards and Training, PPB operates its own Advanced Academy for new officers. The estimated cost per officer is $20,000.

**Coach premiums.** Each trainee is paired with a field training officer during the supervised patrol phase of probation. The premium pay for coaches is estimated at $8,000 per trainee.

**Equipment.** Each new officer requires a full equipment issue, including uniform, body armor, duty weapon, radio, body-worn camera, and other standard-issue items. The estimated cost per officer is $16,000.

Taken together, the all-in cost of hiring and training a single officer through probation is approximately **$345,000**. This figure is particularly important in the context of the bureau's 25% trainee attrition rate discussed earlier in this report. Because roughly one in four trainees separates before completing probation, the effective cost of producing one fully trained officer is higher than the per-trainee investment; the bureau must invest in approximately four trainees to yield three deployable officers.

**Vehicles.** If staffing levels increase, additional patrol vehicles and associated equipment (mobile data terminals, radios, etc.) will be needed. The current Ford Police Interceptor Utility vehicles cost the bureau $70,015 each (including equipment and upfitting). The Bureau purchased 144 in 2023 at a cost of $10,075,603. Each one is estimated to cost in the region of $13,000-$20,000 in fuel and maintenance, not including any damage beyond normal wear and tear.

### *Recruitment*

The Portland Police Bureau's Personnel Division is responsible for all sworn recruitment activities. The division's current annual budget is $5,335,714, which covers sworn recruiters, non-sworn background investigators, digital marketing and social media campaigns, outreach and recruitment travel, and related expenses.

Increasing the bureau's hiring rate beyond the current baseline of 21 officers per quarter would likely require additional investment in recruitment. However, the relationship between recruitment spending and applicant volume is not well established, and recruitment investment is subject to diminishing returns; doubling the recruitment budget would not necessarily double the number of qualified applicants. The effectiveness of recruitment spending depends heavily on labor market conditions, the competitiveness of PPB's compensation relative to other agencies, and broader perceptions of policing as a career. For these reasons, this report does not model a specific recruitment spending increase tied

to a particular hiring target but notes that any scenario that assumes accelerated hiring would likely require additional recruitment investment.

There are potential efficiencies in examining recruitment as a service-area-wide (or even city-wide) activity. While the recruitment pools are different, many of the same approaches and markets are targeted by PF&R and PPB.

### *Overtime offsets*

One of the most significant fiscal effects of increasing sworn staffing would be a reduction in overtime spending. The bureau's FY26 overtime budget is approximately $20 million annually. A substantial portion of this spending funds two categories that would be directly affected by increased staffing: planned mission-based enforcement operations that are currently conducted on overtime because insufficient personnel are available during regular shifts, and personnel backfill overtime used to maintain minimum staffing levels when officers are on leave, in training, or otherwise unavailable.

If the bureau were to achieve a significant increase in staffing, an estimated two-thirds of current overtime spending (approximately $13 million) could be eliminated. Missions that are currently funded through overtime could be conducted on straight time, and personnel gaps could be addressed through a traveler's pool of officers available for backfill assignments, similar to the model used by Portland Fire & Rescue. The remaining one-third of overtime spending reflects operational needs that would persist regardless of staffing levels, such as extended investigations, court appearances, and emergency callouts.

This potential reduction in overtime represents a significant partial offset to the cost of new hires and should be factored into any net cost analysis of staffing expansion. There would be a lag between when officers are hired and when overtime would be reduced for the two years that it takes a new hire to complete training.

### *Revenue offsets*

One identified source of additional revenue that could partially offset the cost of expanding sworn staffing is an expansion of the City's intergovernmental agreement (IGA) with TriMet. The transit agency has expressed interest in increasing the number of PPB patrol officers assigned to transit policing and would reimburse the City for those costs. The current IGA is valued at approximately $1.3 million; the proposed expansion would roughly double that figure to approximately $2.6 million, representing an additional $1.3 million in annual revenue to the bureau, although at the cost of assigning those officers to transit policing rather than other discretionary activities.

### *Retention savings*

While recruitment and training receive significant attention in staffing discussions, the most cost-effective path to increasing net staffing is retaining the officers the bureau has already trained. Every officer who separates before the end of their career represents a loss of the full investment the city made in their recruitment, hiring, training, and professional development and generates a new cycle of costs to recruit, hire, and train a replacement.

At an estimated $345,000 per officer to bring a new hire through probation, each avoidable separation carries a substantial direct cost. Beyond the direct fiscal impact, mid-career separations also result in the loss of institutional knowledge, field experience, and community relationships that take years to develop and cannot be replaced by a new trainee.

Investments in retention (whether through compensation and benefits, workplace culture, professional development, or the wellness initiatives described elsewhere in this report) carry their own costs. However, even modest improvements in retention rates can generate significant savings relative to the cost of replacement hiring. A retention strategy that prevented even ten additional separations per year would avoid approximately $3.5 million in training and onboarding costs annually, in addition to preserving experienced officers in the field.

### *Capital*

In addition to personnel-related costs, the bureau has identified significant capital needs that will arise over the coming decades. Some of these needs exist independent of any staffing expansion; aging facilities require replacement or renovation regardless of the bureau's size. Others would be triggered or accelerated by growth, particularly if the bureau moves toward the four-precinct or expanded-precinct model discussed earlier in this report.

The following is a preliminary, high-level list of capital needs identified for a potential future bond proposal. All figures are early estimates and would be subject to significant scrutiny, detailed planning, and public input before any would be pursued.

**Specialized Resources Division consolidation.** Relocating the bureau's Specialized Resources Division units (currently dispersed across multiple sites) into a single shared facility. Estimated cost: $135 million.

**Quartermaster facility.** Developing a new facility to house the bureau's equipment storage, distribution, and fleet management functions. Estimated cost: $22 million.

**Central Precinct replacement.** Replacing the bureau's footprint in the Justice Center and relocating Central Precinct operations to a new precinct facility in the Old Town area. Estimated cost: $65 million.

**North Precinct replacement and expansion.** Replacing the existing North Precinct with two new precinct facilities in the Kenton and Parkrose areas, supporting both improved geographic coverage and the potential transition to a four-precinct model. Estimated cost: $78 million.

**New SE Precinct.** Developing a new precinct facility to support expansion. Estimated cost: $38 million.

The total estimated capital need across these projects is approximately $338 million. It is important to emphasize that these are conceptual estimates at an early stage of planning. Actual costs would depend on site selection, design, construction market conditions, and the timeline over which projects are pursued. Not all projects would necessarily move forward, and any that did would require Council approval and, in the case of a general obligation bond, voter approval.

## Sustaining Costs

This section estimates the ongoing cost of sustaining increased sworn staffing levels over the next decade under the status quo hiring assumptions described above. It is intended to answer a straightforward question: if the bureau grows as projected, how much more will it cost each year to maintain that larger workforce?

**Methodology and scope:** All cost estimates in this section are presented in non-inflation-adjusted (nominal) dollars, using average, current compensation rates for each job classification. This approach allows for a direct comparison of staffing costs at different points in time without introducing uncertainty from inflation projections, which have varied significantly in recent years and are likely to remain volatile over the coming decade. It is important to note, however, that this approach may understate the actual fiscal impact over time: historically, the rate of growth in personnel costs (driven by negotiated wage increases, healthcare cost escalation, and benefit changes) has outpaced the rate of growth in General Fund revenue. This structural dynamic will need to be accounted for in future budget planning regardless of staffing decisions.

Cost figures reflect the total expense to taxpayers, including both General Fund expenditures and costs reimbursed through the Fire and Police Disability and Retirement (FPDR) levy. The FPDR levy is a dedicated property tax that funds pension and disability benefits for sworn police and fire personnel; while it does not draw from the General Fund, it represents a real cost borne by Portland taxpayers and is included here to present the full fiscal picture.

The model includes the following cost components: the salary and benefit costs for all sworn personnel, adjusted for the changing distribution of staff across pay levels (trainees,

officers, and higher-ranked sworn positions) as the workforce grows and matures over time, less the projected savings from reduced overtime spending as increased staffing allows missions and backfill to be conducted on straight time.

| Sworn Costs | Est total cost (pay, benefits, and pension – not including overtime) |
|---|---|
| Entry level Officer | $120,000-$159,000 |
| Top-step officer | $187,000-$270,000 |
| Sergeant | $230,000-$295,000 |
| Lieutenant | $250,000-$335,000 |
| Captain | $250,000-$345,000 |
| Commander | $336,000-$370,000 |

*Figure12 - Table showing the range of total per person expenses for sworn personnel.*

The model does not include costs for capital facilities, non-sworn support staff that would be needed to support an expanded bureau, recruitment spending, or equipment and vehicle procurement beyond initial officer outfitting. These are addressed separately elsewhere in this report, and any comprehensive fiscal analysis of bureau growth would need to account for them in addition to the personnel costs presented here.

**Findings:** Under the status quo scenario, the bureau would grow from 816 to approximately 1,054 sworn personnel over the next decade - a net increase of 238 filled positions. The chart below shows the quarterly change in personnel costs relative to FY 2026–27 levels. By FY 2035–36, **the annual cost of sustaining this larger sworn workforce is estimated at approximately $37.3 million above current levels**, net of projected overtime savings.

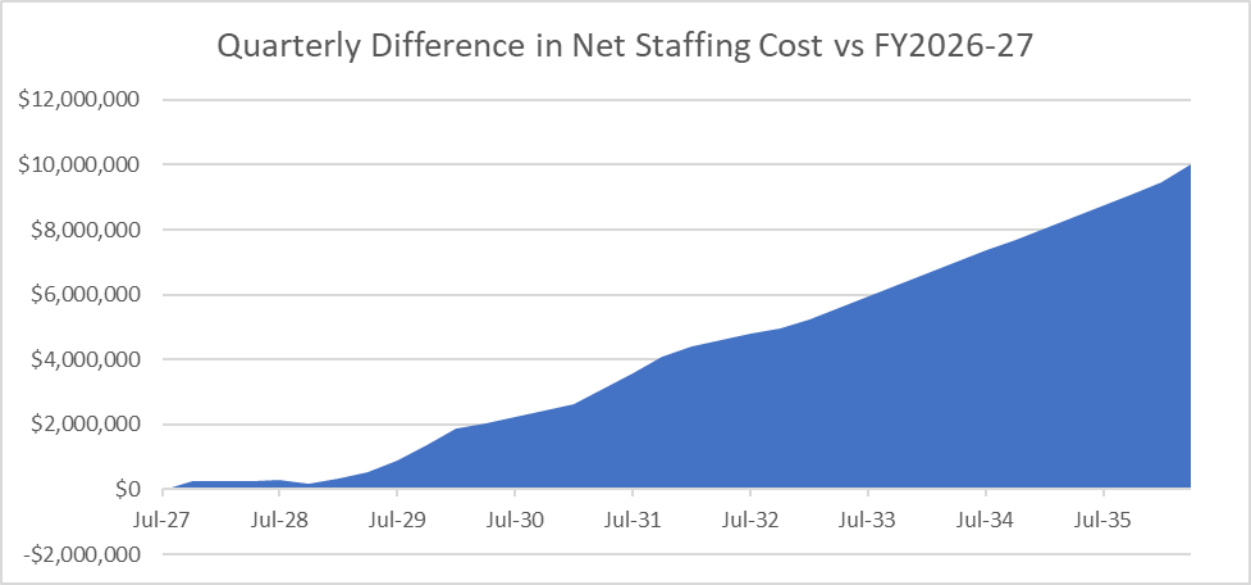



*Figure 13 - Change in quarterly cost of increased sworn staffing under Status Quo hiring model, relative to Fiscal Year FY2026-27.*

This figure represents the recurring annual cost that would need to be absorbed by the General Fund and FPDR levy to maintain the projected sworn staffing level. It does not represent a one-time expense. Once the bureau reaches a given staffing level, this cost would continue and grow in subsequent years as personnel costs increase through contractual wage adjustments and benefit cost escalation, even if no additional officers are hired.

It is also important to note that **this estimate addresses only sworn personnel costs**. If the bureau were to increase staffing significantly, corresponding growth in non-sworn support positions (including records, administrative, training, and analytical staff) would be necessary, as discussed in the section on non-sworn programs. **Capital costs associated with facility replacement and potential new precincts, estimated at approximately $338 million**, would represent an additional long-term fiscal obligation. A complete accounting of the cost of bureau expansion would need to incorporate all of these categories.